

Visual Identity Guide for Creatives

Introduction

The guide on Elections Canada's (EC) corporate visual identity (or brand) should be used to develop all official corporate communication products. The manuals for other sub-types of the brand can be found on the agency's [intranet](#).

There are three versions of this guide:

1. The Visual Identity Guide for Creatives:

Developed for external graphic design and creative professionals, this version outlines the key principles, requirements and restrictions of the identity.

2. The Visual Identity Guide for EC Employees:

Developed for employees of EC headquarters, this version connects to templates while providing instructions on how to use and customize them.

3. Visual Identity: A Complete Guide:

Developed for internal graphic design and creative professionals who apply the corporate identity regularly, this version incorporates both versions above.

This version is the Visual Identity Guide for Creatives.

Visual identity plays an important role in the way the agency presents itself as independent and non-partisan.

When used consistently, our visual identity enables electors and stakeholders to clearly distinguish EC's communications from those of other electoral management bodies, the Government of Canada, political parties, and registered third parties.

It also supports the recognition of our communication and information as being credible and truthful.

If you have any questions about the application of these principles, please contact EC's [Creative Services](#) team.

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01

Consistency: Branding, Voice and Visual Identity

The Value of Consistency

The agency's brand, or reputation, is the public's impression of the agency. It is shaped by their interactions with us and by opinions and information that we share and that others share about us.

We have an opportunity to influence those perceptions with every graphic or visual communication product.

To be effective, people must recognize that those graphics or products come from Elections Canada (EC).

We need to be consistent in order to establish and maintain a recognizable visual identity. Recognition is notably important for disseminating official information and maintaining trust, particularly in environments that include disinformation and misinformation.

Personalizing the Agency's Brand through Warmth and Competency

To support trust and credibility, it is important for diverse audiences to be able to relate to the agency's voice. Creative visual approaches should thus convey a combination of warmth and competency.

We must also convey information and data accurately and clearly.

Where possible, the agency should connect sharable graphics and information to more detailed, related graphics and information.

01

Consistency: Branding, Voice and Visual Identity

Key Principles

Visual communication products should always reflect the authentic “voice” of EC and the Chief Electoral Officer of Canada, as well as the tone of the campaign and subject matter.

In addition to being clear and accurate, graphics and visual products should, wherever possible:

1. Respect the diverse social and political prerogatives of their audience
2. Acknowledge any brands, parties or individuals in a neutral way
3. Reflect the diverse demographic and ethnocultural audiences the agency serves
4. Speak to the variety of perspectives and informational interests of Canadian electors and the agency’s stakeholders
5. Resonate with the audiences who use the products’ medium or channel
6. Emanate integrity and authenticity
7. Accommodate the public’s needs with respect to accessibility and use of plain language

02

Elements (Cheat Sheet)

Elections Canada's visual identity consists of the following elements:

- Logo
- Coat of arms
- Colours
- Fonts

LOGO



COAT OF ARMS



COLOURS

RGB 106 0 50	RGB 0 0 0	RGB 255 255 255
RGB 96 32 92	RGB 30 56 75	RGB 201 134 45
RGB 3 96 100	RGB 139 149 56	RGB 255 218 0 i WAYFINDING COLOUR

FONTS

Gotham Book
Gotham Medium
Gotham Bold

Minion Pro Regular
Minion Pro Medium
Minion Pro Bold

03

Logo

The Elections Canada (EC) logo is comprised of:

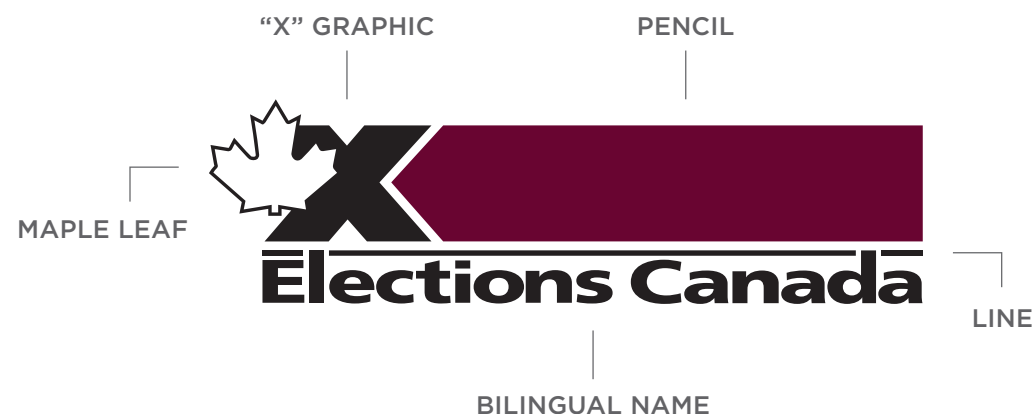
- maple leaf (white or transparent)
- “x” graphic (black)
- pencil (PMS 209)
- line (black)
- bilingual name (black)

The logo must be clearly visible on the cover or first inside page of all branded communications at 100% aspect ratio.

The logo should not be applied any smaller than 1” wide or 72 pixels on screen or at less than 300 DPI at size in print.

Elements of the logo should not be modified in any way.

Use of the logo in graphics of external-facing products must be approved by EC’s Director of Marketing and Corporate Communications. For approvals, contact your [strategic communications advisor](#) or [Creative Services](#).



Logo Colours

BURGUNDY

PMS 209 CP
CMYK 20 97 40 58
RGB 106 0 50
WebSmart 6a0032

BLACK

CMYK 0 0 0 100
RGB 0 0 0
WebSmart #000000

WHITE

CMYK 0 0 0 0
RGB 255 255 255
WebSmart #ffffff

03

Logo

Position

The logo should be viewable at a quick glance on a single page or appear prominently on the front of cover artwork. Apart from stationery and introductory or closing pages or frames, the logo should not appear again unless it is the specific subject of the publication.

There is an area around the logo that must be kept clear or blank. This area ensures that the logo remains prominent and uncluttered.

For print applications, this space must be at least the height of the capital letters of the name in the logo at the size applied, as shown in this diagram.



03

Logo

Applications

To preserve its integrity, the logo should be in full colour where possible, using the colour format of the medium where it appears (RGB, PMS/CMYK, WebSmart).

Correct representations of the logo are presented on the right.

* The reverse logo(s) can be applied to backgrounds of any colouration.

** Square and favourite icon versions are only for use where there is not enough space for the full-size logo to be readable.

FULL COLOUR



BLACK (OR ONE-COLOUR)



REVERSE*



REVERSE FULL COLOUR*



SQUARE**



FAVORITE ICON (FAVICON)**



03

Logo

Incorrect Applications

The applications on the right **cannot be used** in Elections Canada publications or products.

While positioning of the logo over photos is discouraged, certain exceptions may apply where backgrounds are simple, free of visual clutter, sufficiently clear and high-contrast.

STRETCHED (LOOKS PHONY)



FADED/SCREENED (LOSES PENCIL, COMPROMISES RECOGNITION)



DROP SHADOW OR GLOW (LOSES IMPACT, COMPROMISES RECOGNITION)



RE-COLOURATION OF ELEMENTS (COMPROMISES ACCESSIBILITY)



CLOSE TO CONTENT (LOSES IMPACT)



POOR CONTRAST (COMPROMISES ACCESSIBILITY)



04

Colours

Applying Colour Correctly

Always apply colours with sufficient contrast to comply with the current [Government of Canada Standard on Web Accessibility](#).

To support audiences with different types of colour blindness, use a combination of colour contrast and patterns among other approaches when developing data visualizations, charts and tables.

Non-Partisan Colours

As the agency is non-partisan, **avoid** using the colours of Canada's main political parties, or colours similar to these, in EC communication products.

These colours currently include, but are not limited to:



RGB: 0 65 133, currently associated with the Bloc Québécois



RGB: 128 195 66, currently associated with the Bloc Québécois



Pantone 295 C (blue), currently associated with the Conservative Party of Canada



Pantone 2995 C (blue), currently associated with the Conservative Party of Canada



Pantone 362 C (green), currently associated with the Green Party of Canada



Pantone 1795 C (red), currently associated with the Liberal Party of Canada



Pantone 1505 C (orange), currently associated with the New Democratic Party



RGB: 68 45 123 C (purple), currently associated with the the People's Party of Canada

04

Colours

Primary Palette

When To Use It

The primary colour palette is intended for use when recognition is of the utmost importance and when the information or tone of the message is serious. For example, when the agency is correcting mis- or disinformation or communicating about serious issues such as the COVID-19 pandemic, the audience must be able to recognize that the information is from Elections Canada (EC) and, therefore, credible.

Burgundy is EC's corporate colour and should, therefore, be prominently featured in all visual communication products.



PMS 108 CP is to be used only in the field as a **wayfinding colour**.

CORPORATE COLOUR

CMYK 20 97 40 58

RGB 106 0 50

WebSmart 6a0032

PANTONE 209 CP



CMYK 0 0 0 100

RGB 0 0 0

WebSmart 000000



CMYK 90 71 48 43

RGB 30 56 75

WebSmart 1e384b



CMYK 67 100 33 23

RGB 96 32 92

WebSmart 60205c



CMYK 91 46 53 24

RGB 3 96 100

WebSmart 036064



CMYK 49 28 100 6

RGB 139 149 56

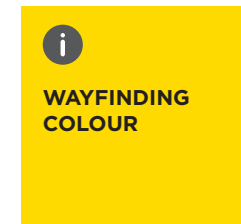
WebSmart 8b9538



CMYK 20 51 98 2

RGB 201 134 45

WebSmart c9862d

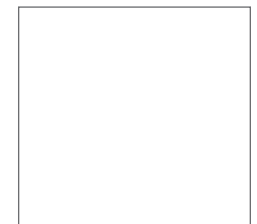


PMS 108 CP

CMYK 2 11 100 0

RGB 255 218 0

WebSmart ffd400



CMYK 0 0 0 0

RGB 255 255 255

WebSmart ffffff

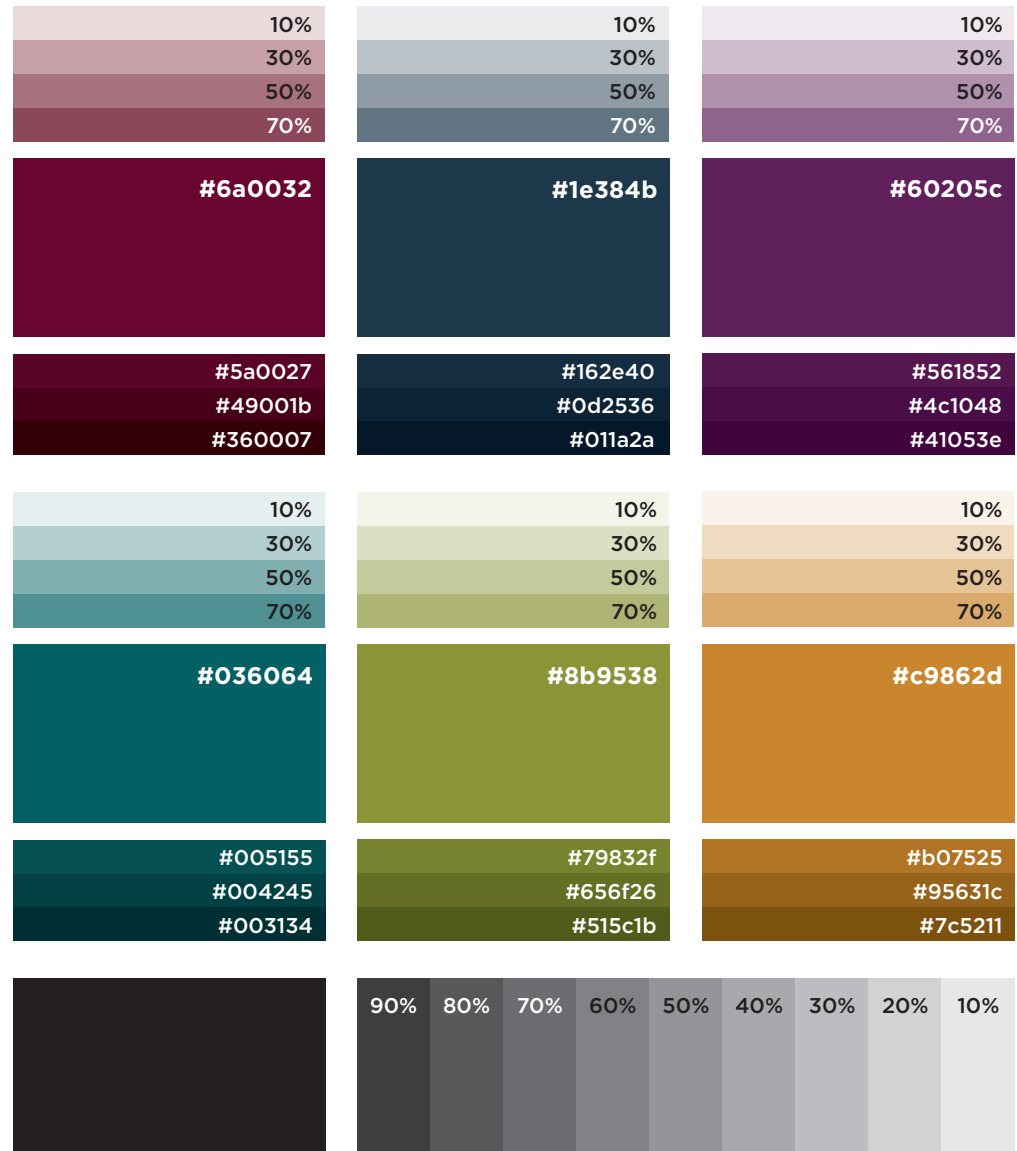
04

Colours

Secondary Palette

When To Use It

The secondary colour palette (right) is intended for use when recognition is of lesser importance than emotion and/or when the tone is less serious—for example, when the agency is observing statutory holidays, celebrating achievements, acknowledging historical milestones, or reaching out on channels designed for more personal engagement.



05

Fonts

Primary

Elections Canada's primary fonts are Open type, work on PC and Mac operating systems, and offer a number of typefaces to choose from.

Creative Flexibility

While our sans serif fonts (Gotham and Arial) should be used for impactful headlines and our serif fonts (Garamond and Times New Roman), for supporting readable body text, either font type could be used where text is sparse. They each offer a variety of typefaces to choose from.

Gotham

Aa

Light

Book

Book Italic

Medium

Medium Italic

Bold

Bold Italic

Black

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
0123456789!@#\$%?&*()

Minion Pro

Aa

Regular

Italic

Medium

Medium Italic

Semibold

Semibold Italic

Bold

Bold Italic

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
0123456789!@#\$%?&*()

05

Fonts

Secondary

The secondary fonts (right) can be used when primary fonts are unavailable to the user.

Arial

Aa

Regular
Italic

Bold
Bold Italic

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
0123456789!@#\$%?&*()

Times New Roman

Aa

Regular
Italic

Bold
Bold Italic

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
0123456789!@#\$%?&*()

05

Fonts

Hierarchy

Establishing a visual hierarchy is important in design, including when applying type. The hierarchy helps to show the reader what should be read first and, as it shows relationship, ensures that the reader understands how to relate to the content.

On the right is an example of a visual hierarchy of fonts. Notice the use of typeface, size, spacing and colour and how it delineates specific elements.

TITLE: GOTHAM BOLD, 30 PTS, BLACK

Title of text

Subtitle of text — SUBTITLE: GOTHAM MEDIUM, 18 PTS, BURGUNDY

Body of text. Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur qua adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Dictumst quisque sagittis purus sit amet mauris. Mauris rhoncus aenean vel elit scelerisque ota mauris. Tincidunt tortor aliquam nulla facilisi cras fermentum odio eu feugiat. In tellusim intege feugiat scelerisque varius.

BODY:
GOTHAM BOOK,
11 PTS,
BLACK

At volutpat diam ut venenatis tellus in metus vulputa. Lectus maga fringilla urna porttitor rhoncus. Ninisro condimentum id venenatis a condimentum vitae sed sapien. Sed viverra tellus in hac habitasse platea uta dictumst. Ornare lectus sit amet est placer in.

Call to action. Tincidunt tortor aliquam nulla facilis cras fermentum odio eu feugiat.

CALL TO ACTION: GOTHAM BOLD, 11 PTS, BURGUNDY

06

Graphic Components

These are components that may be included or considered in addition to the core brand elements such as the logo, colour palette and font.

Coat of Arms of Canada

The Coat of Arms of Canada is an official symbol of the Government of Canada, used to identify institutions whose heads report directly to Parliament, among others.

Elections Canada applies the Coat of Arms of Canada to:

- statutory reports
- the website landing page



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Graphic Components

Half X

The half X is the focal point of EC's visual identity. It should appear on all visual communications products where branding and visual recognition are important.

In some cases, it may be used to inspire fresh creative approaches through its use of whitespace, diagonal lines and the corporate colour palette. In those cases, approval must be received from EC's Director of Marketing and Corporate Communication Services before publishing.



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Graphic Components

Half X Layout

Situated on a white or light-grey background, the half x must always appear upright and on the left or right side of the page, whether the publication is in landscape or portrait format.

The half x bleeds off the top or bottom of the cover (printed to the edge so that there is no margin), as in the examples.

The large boxes in the half x may be populated with one or more photos or coloured using colours in the approved colour palette.

EC's corporate burgundy should always be the focal colour within the half x. However, the combination of colours may vary, using those in the approved colour palette.

The publication's title, subtitle, date, logos, URL and/or social media icons should appear adjacent to the half x, in a clear text box.

On a letter-sized cover (8.5 x 11 inches), the main title font should be Gotham or Arial Bold, no smaller than 20 points and no larger than 72 points, with a contrast of 3:1.

For accessibility, remember to add alt text to graphics, including decorative graphics.



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Graphic Components

Web Address and Social Media Icons

The agency's web address, **elections.ca**, should appear prominently on the first or last outward-facing page, panel or screen of the visual communications product. Where applicable, it may be replaced by a more precise web address, such as elections.ca/jobs.

The web address should be accompanied by the icons that represent EC's social media channels (Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, Twitter and YouTube). This treatment makes it clear where EC's corporate presence can be found.

elections.ca



elections.ca



06

Graphic Components

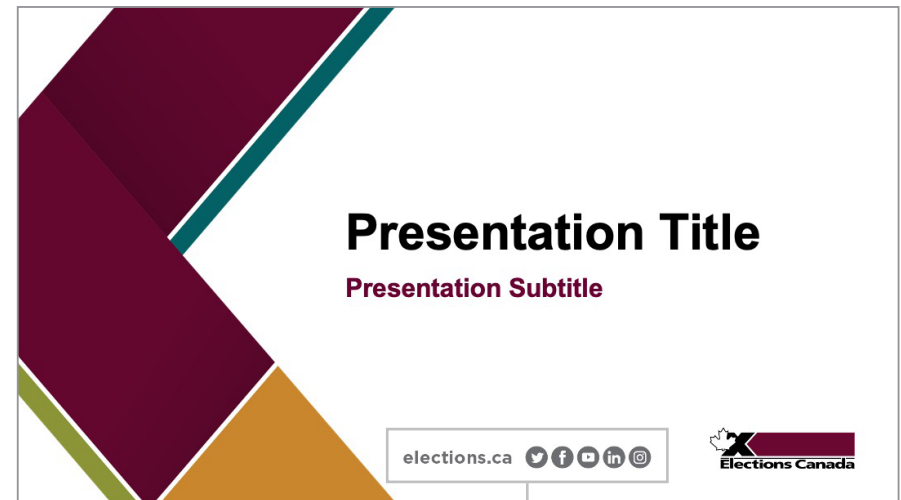
Web Address and Social Media Icons

Layout

The web address should be aligned at the left or right, in the lowermost corner of the page, panel or screen.

The web address should always be notably smaller than the title of the document, panel or screen. Its size should be consistent with that of the social media icons, where they appear together.

The only exception to including the web address relates to visuals that are communicated from the agency's social media accounts, where the web address appears on the agency's profile page. In this case, the web address is repeated only for content that is elaborated on the EC website or where branding is considered important, such as content that provides election facts and information.



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Graphic Components

Photography

EC has a diverse collection of custom photography; it is accessible through subject-specific portals of the Image Bank.

Image Bank portals are accessible to Elections Canada staff through a [page on the intranet site](#).

The Creative Services team is also able to provide royalty-free images for agency communications, upon request.

Before using any photos that are not found in the agency's image bank, it is important to ensure that you have the appropriate rights and permissions to do so.

For support, or if you cannot find the photo you are seeking, please contact Elections Canada's [Creative Services team](#).



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Graphic Components

Iconography

EC has dozens of icons available for use in its communications products; some are shown here.

Background graphics in each of the colours of our primary palette are available as well.

Additional icons can be made available or created on request; please contact the [Creative Services team](#).



07

Contact Information

Please contact Elections Canada's (EC) Creative Services team if:

- you require creative services
- you have any questions about how to apply the visual identity
- you need a different version of this manual
- you would like to obtain visual guidance for the agency's Voter Information Campaign or Civic Education Program
- you have difficulty accessing or customizing related graphics or templates

Elections Canada employees can also view the visual guidance for the [Voter Information Campaign](#) and [Civic Education](#) themselves.